

Three Types of Introductions

Below are three essay introductions that use different methods to lead the reader to the topic at hand while delivering a thesis statement in the last sentence of the introduction, which is the norm for college level essays.

Example introduction One: The Inverted Triangle Introduction leads the audience from the general (topic) to the specific (thesis) In other words, you start broadly by speaking in general terms about a topic. If you are writing about literacy you can begin by mentioning our educational system or reading and writing. Example One is from a literacy narrative on the difficulties of learning to read, write, and speak English as a second language.

Everyday across America, millions of people rush off to work or set off for college without thinking about how much of their daily lives revolve around literacy skills. In order to be successful in our society, a person generally has to be good at reading, writing and speaking. For some people, these skills come naturally. These types of learners often have positive childhood memories such as the first time they learned to write a complete sentence or read aloud a difficult word. Essentially, they thrive at school when it comes to literacy. For others, learning to read, write and speak well is not as easily accomplished. Conversely, they have painful memories of English language lessons where they struggled and suffered through class lessons. **My literacy development was turned upside down when my family moved to the United States and I had to learn English as a second language.**

Example Introduction Two: The Interrogative Introduction asks a question as it leads the audience to the topic at hand. You only need to ask one question and then move toward unpacking the question in general terms. Example Two is from an essay on homelessness.

Have you ever wondered why it is becoming harder and harder for some Americans to find even the most basic housing? Afterall, most people have comfortable living spaces. They can wake up, go for a morning walk or head off to the gym. Others lounge around the house welcoming the day slowly. This can include a sumptuous breakfast and a cup of specialty grade

coffee. Those are the fortunate Americans. There is, however, another class of citizens who are not as lucky. They stir awake every morning under an overpass or first see the morning light as it filters their tents in abandoned lots or along the freeway. Unfortunately, there are no easy solutions for America's rampant homelessness. **One thing is readily apparent when it comes to homelessness: Criminalizing homelessness simply doesn't work.**

Example Introduction Three: A Narrative Introduction tells a story as it raises the topic and delivers the thesis. People are drawn to stories. Tell them one and introduce the topic as you move toward ending the paragraph with a thesis statement. Example three is from an essay on parental oversight of their children's social media usage.

On a quiet street in the Bushwick section of Brooklyn, Linda kisses her daughter goodbye on the cheek every night of the week as she heads off to work. Like many other junior high students across America, Stephanie has to stay at home without adult supervision because there is simply nobody to watch her. On a good night, Stephanie does some chores and follows with a couple of hours of school work. As she has gotten older, those good nights have gotten increasingly rare. Instead Stephanie usually gets lost in creating her latest TikTok or just watches videos. Some nights she spends hours on Snapchat, ignoring her school work and the work her mother has left for her to do. Unfortunately, Linda was recently notified that Stephanie arrives at school lethargic and has started falling asleep in class. Out of control social media usage has been the cause of problems like these across America. **Parents and school districts need to better monitor the social media accounts of young people before consequences derail the academic pursuits.**